

CS105 Practical 1 2024-2025

For CS105 you will initially use BlueJ - an integrated development environment (IDE) for Java. Later in first semester we will switch to using the IntelliJ IDE.

This practical is very short and may be done in a university lab or off-campus. If you have questions or run in to difficulties, please go to the week 2 drop-in lab (Wed 1-3 in LT1201 & 1221 to speak with a lab demonstrator) or ask on mattermost.

Optional - Installing BlueJ on your own machine

If you are working in a PC in a university lab, BlueJ is already installed. This section is only if you wish sometimes to be able to work from a laptop/ PC of your own.

To download and install BlueJ on your own machine:

Go to <https://www.bluej.org/> in a web browser.

Select the appropriate version to download. if you are using Windows, this will download the MSI Installer. It may take a few minutes to download. Once downloaded, select the installer (msi file) – this should take you to the BlueJ Setup Wizard. Follow the instructions in the wizard – you can accept the options offered.

(If you are using an alternative to Windows, please select the appropriate option to download and install.)

Obtaining your own copy of BlueJ Projects

With module CS105 we will be taking a project-based teaching approach, working with existing projects many of which are supplied with the text book and building on these. Initially we will work with projects referred to in chapter 1 of the text book.

You will need your own copy of the relevant BlueJ projects in order to work with them and edit them. These will be provided in zip files from the CS105 MyPlace page as the class progresses.

You will first need to decide where you wish to store your files for the time being. The University currently recommends OneDrive for Business if you wish to be able to access your files both on and off-campus.

For information and use of OneDrive for Business see:

<https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/informationsservices/it/saveshare/onedrive/>

If you have not yet set this up or choose not to, you may use the H: drive if you are working on any University PC or store files for this module on your own laptop (if you have one).

After deciding where you wish to store your files for now, create a folder where you will keep your CS105 work. I'll call the folder CS105 here in these notes although you may call it what you wish. On the CS105 MyPlace page, right click on the zip file

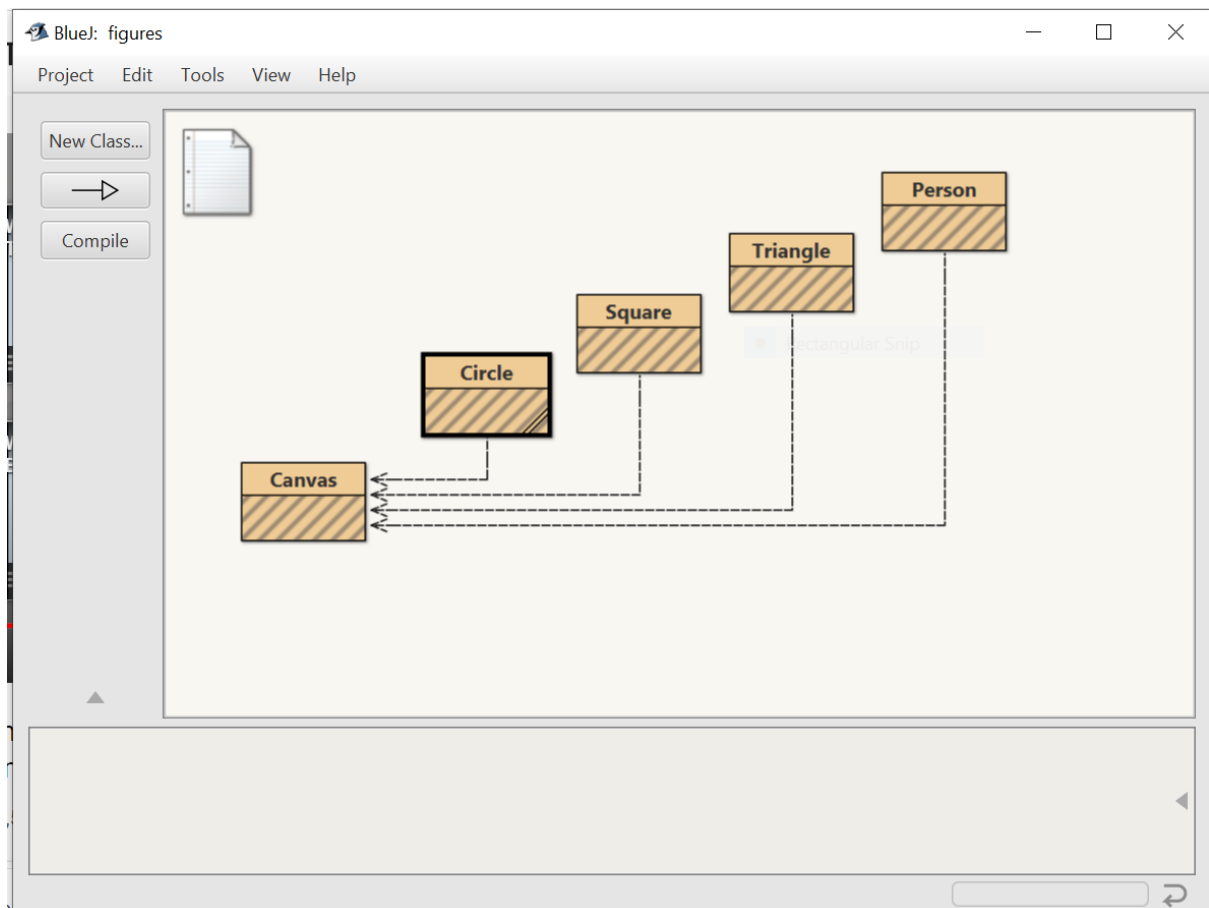
"BlueJ Projects Chapter 1" and choose "Save Link As ...". Save the file in your newly created folder CS105. You should now have a file called chapter01.zip in your CS105 folder. The chapter01.zip is a zip file containing example projects from Chapter 1 of the text book. It must be unzipped. This can be done by right-clicking on it (then clicking OK on the Windows Security message screen if it appears), selecting "Extract All" from the menu and selecting the offered destination. Have a brief look inside the folder that has been created to see that there are Java projects (figures, house, labclasses) provided.

First use of BlueJ

Find (e.g. type BlueJ in the search box of Windows) and run the BlueJ App.

From the Project menu choose Open Project. Find and select the **figures** project from the Chapter 1 projects you saved.

If you have been successful you should see a screen that looks something like this:



Practical 2 will introduce you to BlueJ by using the Chapter 1 example projects. For now in practical 1, close BlueJ e.g. by choosing Quit from the Project menu.

Marking practical 1 as complete

If you have successfully completed this short Practical, please mark as done on the CS105 MyPlace page.

Martin Goodfellow
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